



SIT223-SIT753

Distinction Task: Design Thinking



Design Thinking

Overview

The Design Thinking RapidS resources have been carefully prepared through close collaboration between the SIT223–SIT753 unit and the Capstone unit, specifically tailored for students aiming for **Distinction** and **High Distinction** grades.

These exclusive online resources embrace the core principles of design thinking to foster a creative and systematic approach to problem-solving and innovation. Students aspiring to excel are encouraged to immerse themselves in this dynamic environment, where they will engage with the design thinking process to generate and refine innovative product ideas for their chosen company's Capstone project. A complete list of company profiles will be available in Week 2.

Throughout the [RapidS Design Thinking resources available on the Unit Site](#), students will have a unique opportunity to apply design thinking methodologies — empathising with users, defining pain points, ideating solutions, and pitching their ideas. This approach is essential for developing an individual concept that is not only innovative but also viable and user-centred, forming the foundation for the artefacts they will create for their selected Capstone company.

Active engagement with these online resources is key, as they are designed to simulate real-world challenges, offering practical experience in the field and the opportunity to hone skills essential for future innovation leaders.

Achieving a distinction

To achieve a **Distinction**, you must meet all the requirements for a **Pass**, a **Credit**, and a **Distinction** conditions.

These conditions serve as guidelines — it is your **responsibility** to demonstrate to your tutor that you have met or exceeded them and therefore **deserve** this grade.

- You must contribute to **ALL** RapidS project process requirements, including the **pitch video**, **Idea Canvas**, **product backlog Trello board**, and **low-fidelity Figma prototype**.
- All contributions to the project must be of a very high standard.

Assessment Instructions

The online resources are designed to provide you with a comprehensive understanding of the Capstone projects, while also offering the opportunity to develop new skills and gain valuable experience that will support your success in future Capstone units and your IT career.

The submission includes the following two parts.

1. Part 1: Self-reflection report

The goal of this assessment is to help you deepen your understanding of your experiences and develop a plan for ongoing professional development. By reflecting on your journey and setting clear goals, you can leverage the skills and knowledge gained through the online resources to support your career advancement in the IT industry.

Your professional development plan should follow the SMART framework — Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound — and include a timeline to help you stay on track and make adjustments as needed. Providing evidence to support your reflections and evaluations will enable you to better articulate your learning and growth throughout the design thinking experience.

Your reflection should be between **1000 and 1200 words**, written in essay format. Your submission must include the following sections:

Introduction: Provide an introduction to your design thinking experience, including the company you selected and the problem you focused on.

Learning objectives: Describe the learning objectives you set for yourself at the start of engaging with the online resources. What did you hope to learn or achieve during this experience?

Skill assessments: Assess your skills based on what you observed and learned while engaging with the RapidS online resources. What are your key strengths, and how did you leverage them during this experience? What skills or areas do you need to improve, and how can you work on them? [Provide examples to support your assessment.](#)

Project reflections: Reflect on the project ideas and problems you worked on during the workshop activities. What did you learn from the project? What challenges did you face, and how did you overcome them? What were your successes, and how did you achieve them? [Provide specific examples and evidence to support your reflections.](#)

Professional development plan: A professional development plan allows you to create a strategy to address the gaps in your skills identified through online resources. The strategy should include both short-term and long-term actions to address these gaps as outlined below:

- a. **Identify Skill Gaps:** Provide details of all the gaps you recognise in your skills. For each identified gap, draft a plan outlining how you can address and improve these areas to ensure success in similar positions.
- b. **Plan Specificity:** Your professional development plan should be specific, achievable, and realistic. Include as many details as possible. For example, if your plan is to improve your web development skills, clearly define which technologies you aim to learn or improve upon. Identify which university units you plan to enrol in to support this goal, which projects you will seek to be involved in, and whether there are opportunities for real-world experience, such as capstone projects, placements, or industry internships. [Provide specific action items and supporting evidence for your plan.](#)

- c. **Timeline for Implementation:** Develop a timeline for implementing your professional development plan. When will you start? What milestones and deadlines do you need to meet before starting the Capstone project?

Conclusion: Summarise your key insights and takeaways from the RapidS experience.

2. Part 2: RapidS Experience Outcomes

As a participant engaging with the [RapidS online resources](#), you will apply design thinking to propose a completely new product idea OR significant **novel extension** to an existing project for one of the [Capstone companies](#). Extensions must be impactful at Distinction level. **You are NOT permitted to use pre-recorded RapidS workshop ideas.** You must submit the following:

- **[A 3-minute Idea Pitch](#):** Create an engaging pitch to promote and recruit team members for your capstone project. Your pitch should clearly highlight the problem your project addresses, your target audience, your unique value proposition, and the potential impact of your product or service.
- **[A Completed Idea Canvas](#):** Summarise the key elements of your capstone project in an Idea Canvas. This should include the problem statement, target customer, solution, and value proposition.
- **[A Product Plan AND Roadmap \(Trello Board\)](#):** Develop a product plan and roadmap using Trello. Your plan should outline key milestones, tasks, and deadlines for your capstone project. Be sure to prioritise features, estimate efforts, and include user stories to guide your project development.
- **[A Lo-Fi Prototype](#):** Design a low-fidelity prototype that demonstrates the core features of your product or service. Your prototype should be simple, clear, and easy to understand.

Once you have completed these items, upload them to a OneDrive folder and [share the link](#) with your [Marker](#) (you can check who your marker is by checking feedback given on individual ontrack tasks in the chats) AND [Unit Chair](#). It is recommended that you grant access to everyone with the links to ensure that both of these people have access.

Critical: Both must have access, or your task won't be marked complete for Distinction. Set permission to "Anyone with the link can view."

Important Notes:

1. Part 2 - "RapidS Experience Outcomes":

For this task, you must apply what you've learned about design thinking and ideation development to one of the capstone companies listed in the unit content. You must propose **a completely new idea** aligned with the company's expertise, or create a novel, impactful, Distinction-level extension of an existing project by **adding significant functionality** or major components. **Ideas from the pre-recorded RapidS workshop CANNOT be chosen for Part 2.**

2. Pitch Video Guidelines:

Your pitch video must be clear, engaging, and direct, mimicking the style of a real-world entrepreneur or innovator pitching an idea to attract a team or investors. Avoid using traditional slide decks with narrated explanations. Instead, speak directly to the camera (or use a voiceover) to focus on explaining your idea, its value, and why others should be interested in joining your project. The aim is to promote your idea dynamically and persuasively, not to formally present research or documentation. Keep it concise and impactful.

3. Prototyping your idea

You are not required to implement or code your idea. Instead, your task is to create a prototype (e.g., mockups or wireframes). To assist with this, you may use tools such as Figma or AI-assisted platforms such as [Lovable](#) to generate polished and professional UI pages.

Submission Guidelines

- Submit **Part 1 (Self-reflection Report)** and **Part 2 (RapidS Experience Outcomes)** via the [provided template](#) on onTrack.
- **Important:**
 - Ensure access is granted to both your **Marker** and **Unit Chair**.
 - Verify all links embedded in your PDF are functional prior to submission. Non-functional links will result in access failure.
 - Submit both your shared folder link and video link directly in the OnTrack chatbox as additional verification.
 - Test each link personally to confirm they direct to the correct folder and video content for both required parties.

Critical Note:

- 7.4D allows 2 submissions total (**initial submission** → **feedback** → **1 resubmission**). After your first submission receives feedback, revise and make your final resubmission. No further submissions allowed.
- Final status will be marked Complete, Feedback Exceeded, or Time Exceeded based on submission timing.
- Don't forget to ensure your marker and unit chair have access to these files, so you are not wasting the only feedback opportunity you will get.